

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Indian Moral Thinkers and Philosophers - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Indian Moral Thinkers and Philosophers

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

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| 1 The realist-idealist spectrum in Indian moral thought | 2 Kautilya: structural realism and anti-corruption design |
| 3 Buddha: the Middle Path as an administrative decision-procedure | 4 Gandhi: ends-means unity, trusteeship and Seven Social Sins |
| 5 Vivekananda: Practical Vedanta and Daridra Narayana | 6 Basava: Kayaka, Dasoha and the Anubhava Mantapa |
| 7 Guru Nanak: Kirat Karo, Vand Chhako and public-resource ethics | 8 Mahavir: Mahavratas, Anekantavada and multi-stakeholder ethics |
| 9 Ambedkar: constitutional morality, equality and fraternity | 10 Social capital, comparative synthesis and exam application |

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Generation: learner-v2:g1 **PYQ ownership:** Questions labelled as official reproduce the locally held UPSC GS-IV papers; routed historical demands are explicitly neutral renderings rather than invented quotations.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

A state government designs a procurement system with mandatory dual-custody of financial approvals and automatic rotation of purchasing officers every two years. Which Indian moral thinker's structural premise most directly justifies this design over a purely pledge-based integrity programme? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Kautilya's Arthashastra treats official corruption as an opportunity-driven structural phenomenon rather than a personal moral failing; the honey-and-poison passage (Kangle 2.9.32, cited in ARC Annexure-I(2)) argues that an official dealing with the king's money can no more avoid tasting it than a tongue can avoid tasting honey or poison placed on its surface.
- B. Gandhi's trusteeship and Satyagraha assume that moral transformation is possible through exemplar-based self-purification and non-violent persuasion; this idealist premise drives internal, character-based reform and contrasts with Kautilya's reliance on external control mechanisms.
- C. India's modern anti-corruption architecture is structurally closer to Kautilya's control-based realism (statutory controls, vigilance machinery, Lokpal) than to Gandhi's exemplar-based idealism, yet invokes Gandhian language of integrity as a civilisational value in its public rhetoric.
- D. An anti-corruption regime built entirely on Kautilyan surveillance without any Gandhian or Vivekanandan appeal to service-motivation risks demoralising honest officials; the ARC cautions against excessive suspicion that discourages legitimate risk-taking.

Answer: A

Explanation: **Kautilya assumes temptation is structural** is the controlling principle. Kautilya's Arthashastra treats official corruption as an opportunity-driven structural phenomenon rather than a personal moral failing; the honey-and-poison passage (Kangle 2.9.32, cited in ARC Annexure-I(2)) argues that an official dealing with the king's money can no more avoid tasting it than a tongue can avoid tasting honey or poison placed on its surface. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 2

A department head insists that good character training alone will eliminate corruption and resists instituting surprise audits. Which classical Indian passage warns that this reliance on moral goodwill alone is insufficient? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. India's modern anti-corruption architecture is structurally closer to Kautilya's control-based realism (statutory controls, vigilance machinery, Lokpal) than to Gandhi's exemplar-based idealism, yet invokes Gandhian language of integrity as a civilisational value in its public rhetoric.
- B. Kautilya's Arthashastra treats official corruption as an opportunity-driven structural phenomenon rather than a personal moral failing; the honey-and-poison passage (Kangle 2.9.32, cited in ARC Annexure-I(2)) argues that an official dealing with the king's money can no more avoid tasting it than a tongue can avoid tasting honey or poison placed on its surface.
- C. An anti-corruption regime built entirely on Kautilyan surveillance without any Gandhian or Vivekanandan appeal to service-motivation risks demoralising honest officials; the ARC cautions against excessive suspicion that discourages legitimate risk-taking.
- D. Gandhi's trusteeship and Satyagraha assume that moral transformation is possible through exemplar-based self-purification and non-violent persuasion; this idealist premise drives internal, character-based reform and contrasts with Kautilya's reliance on external control mechanisms.

Answer: B

Explanation: **Kautilya assumes temptation is structural** is the controlling principle. Kautilya's Arthashastra treats official corruption as an opportunity-driven structural phenomenon rather than a personal moral failing; the honey-and-poison passage (Kangle 2.9.32, cited in ARC Annexure-I(2)) argues that an official dealing with the king's money can no more avoid tasting it than a tongue can avoid tasting honey or poison placed on its surface. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 3

A senior district official leads by personal example, refusing gifts publicly and expecting subordinates to follow suit without any formal surveillance mechanism. Which Indian moral framework underpins this approach and what is its structural limitation? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Kautilya's Arthashastra treats official corruption as an opportunity-driven structural phenomenon rather than a personal moral failing; the honey-and-poison passage (Kangle 2.9.32, cited in ARC Annexure-I(2)) argues that an official dealing with the king's money can no more avoid tasting it than a tongue can avoid tasting honey or poison placed on its surface.
- B. India's modern anti-corruption architecture is structurally closer to Kautilya's control-based realism (statutory controls, vigilance machinery, Lokpal) than to Gandhi's exemplar-based idealism, yet invokes Gandhian language of integrity as a civilisational value in its public rhetoric.
- C. Gandhi's trusteeship and Satyagraha assume that moral transformation is possible through exemplar-based self-purification and non-violent persuasion; this idealist premise drives internal, character-based reform and contrasts with Kautilya's reliance on external control mechanisms.
- D. An anti-corruption regime built entirely on Kautilyan surveillance without any Gandhian or Vivekanandan appeal to service-motivation risks demoralising honest officials; the ARC cautions against excessive suspicion that discourages legitimate risk-taking.

Answer: C

Explanation: **Gandhi assumes moral transformation through self-purification** is the controlling principle. Gandhi's trusteeship and Satyagraha assume that moral transformation is possible through exemplar-based self-purification and non-violent persuasion; this idealist premise drives internal, character-based reform and contrasts with Kautilya's reliance on external control mechanisms. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 4

A civil servant argues that integrity pledges and public commitments by senior leaders are more effective than vigilance machinery in building a corruption-free organisation. Which thinker's idealist premise does this echo and what is the ARC's implicit caution? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. India's modern anti-corruption architecture is structurally closer to Kautilya's control-based realism (statutory controls, vigilance machinery, Lokpal) than to Gandhi's exemplar-based idealism, yet invokes Gandhian language of integrity as a civilisational value in its public rhetoric.
- B. An anti-corruption regime built entirely on Kautilyan surveillance without any Gandhian or Vivekanandan appeal to service-motivation risks demoralising honest officials; the ARC cautions against excessive suspicion that discourages legitimate risk-taking.
- C. Kautilya's Arthashastra treats official corruption as an opportunity-driven structural phenomenon rather than a personal moral failing; the honey-and-poison passage (Kangle 2.9.32, cited in ARC Annexure-I(2)) argues that an official dealing with the king's money can no more avoid tasting it than a tongue can avoid tasting honey or poison placed on its surface.
- D. Gandhi's trusteeship and Satyagraha assume that moral transformation is possible through exemplar-based self-purification and non-violent persuasion; this idealist premise drives internal, character-based reform and contrasts with Kautilya's reliance on external control mechanisms.

Answer: D

Explanation: Gandhi assumes moral transformation through self-purification is the controlling principle.

Gandhi's trusteeship and Satyagraha assume that moral transformation is possible through exemplar-based self-purification and non-violent persuasion; this idealist premise drives internal, character-based reform and contrasts with Kautilya's reliance on external control mechanisms. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 5

A Lokpal investigation relies on asset-declaration analysis and bank-transaction audits while the official campaign poster quotes Gandhian values. Which analytical claim about India's dual ethical heritage does this illustrate? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. India's modern anti-corruption architecture is structurally closer to Kautilya's control-based realism (statutory controls, vigilance machinery, Lokpal) than to Gandhi's exemplar-based idealism, yet invokes Gandhian language of integrity as a civilisational value in its public rhetoric.
- B. Kautilya's Arthashastra treats official corruption as an opportunity-driven structural phenomenon rather than a personal moral failing; the honey-and-poison passage (Kangle 2.9.32, cited in ARC Annexure-I(2)) argues that an official dealing with the king's money can no more avoid tasting it than a tongue can avoid tasting honey or poison placed on its surface.
- C. Gandhi's trusteeship and Satyagraha assume that moral transformation is possible through exemplar-based self-purification and non-violent persuasion; this idealist premise drives internal, character-based reform and contrasts with Kautilya's reliance on external control mechanisms.
- D. An anti-corruption regime built entirely on Kautilyan surveillance without any Gandhian or Vivekanandan appeal to service-motivation risks demoralising honest officials; the ARC cautions against excessive suspicion that discourages legitimate risk-taking.

Answer: A

Explanation: Modern anti-corruption is Kautilyan in design but Gandhian in aspiration is the controlling principle.

India's modern anti-corruption architecture is structurally closer to Kautilya's control-based realism (statutory controls, vigilance machinery, Lokpal) than to Gandhi's exemplar-based idealism, yet invokes Gandhian language of integrity as a civilisational value in its public rhetoric. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 6

A reform commission recommends both a statutory Lokpal with investigative powers and a Gandhian code-of-ethics module for all civil servants. Why does the commission's package embody a synthesis rather than a contradiction? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Gandhi's trusteeship and Satyagraha assume that moral transformation is possible through exemplar-based self-purification and non-violent persuasion; this idealist premise drives internal, character-based reform and contrasts with Kautilya's reliance on external control mechanisms.
- B. India's modern anti-corruption architecture is structurally closer to Kautilya's control-based realism (statutory controls, vigilance machinery, Lokpal) than to Gandhi's exemplar-based idealism, yet invokes Gandhian language of integrity as a civilisational value in its public rhetoric.
- C. An anti-corruption regime built entirely on Kautilyan surveillance without any Gandhian or Vivekanandan appeal to service-motivation risks demoralising honest officials; the ARC cautions against excessive suspicion that discourages legitimate risk-taking.
- D. Kautilya's Arthashastra treats official corruption as an opportunity-driven structural phenomenon rather than a personal moral failing; the honey-and-poison passage (Kangle 2.9.32, cited in ARC Annexure-I(2)) argues that an official dealing with the king's money can no more avoid tasting it than a tongue can avoid tasting honey or poison placed on its surface.

Answer: B

Explanation: Modern anti-corruption is Kautilyan in design but Gandhian in aspiration is the controlling principle. India's modern anti-corruption architecture is structurally closer to Kautilya's control-based realism (statutory controls, vigilance machinery, Lokpal) than to Gandhi's exemplar-based idealism, yet invokes Gandhian language of integrity as a civilisational value in its public rhetoric. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 7

After a corruption scandal a state government introduces mandatory CCTV in every office, keystroke logging and weekly asset checks. Honest officers feel distrusted and begin avoiding any discretionary decision. Which analytical boundary explains this backfire? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Kautilya's Arthashastra treats official corruption as an opportunity-driven structural phenomenon rather than a personal moral failing; the honey-and-poison passage (Kangle 2.9.32, cited in ARC Annexure-I(2)) argues that an official dealing with the king's money can no more avoid tasting it than a tongue can avoid tasting honey or poison placed on its surface.
- B. Gandhi's trusteeship and Satyagraha assume that moral transformation is possible through exemplar-based self-purification and non-violent persuasion; this idealist premise drives internal, character-based reform and contrasts with Kautilya's reliance on external control mechanisms.
- C. An anti-corruption regime built entirely on Kautilyan surveillance without any Gandhian or Vivekanandan appeal to service-motivation risks demoralising honest officials; the ARC cautions against excessive suspicion that discourages legitimate risk-taking.
- D. India's modern anti-corruption architecture is structurally closer to Kautilya's control-based realism (statutory controls, vigilance machinery, Lokpal) than to Gandhi's exemplar-based idealism, yet invokes Gandhian language of integrity as a civilisational value in its public rhetoric.

Answer: C

Explanation: A regime built entirely on surveillance demoralises honest officials is the controlling principle. An anti-corruption regime built entirely on Kautilyan surveillance without any Gandhian or Vivekanandan appeal to service-motivation risks demoralising honest officials; the ARC cautions against excessive suspicion that discourages legitimate risk-taking. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 8

A district collector pairs vigilance mechanisms with a mentoring programme, public recognition for exemplary service and protected dissent channels. Which synthesis principle is she applying to avoid the demoralisation risk? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Gandhi's trusteeship and Satyagraha assume that moral transformation is possible through exemplar-based self-purification and non-violent persuasion; this idealist premise drives internal, character-based reform and contrasts with Kautilya's reliance on external control mechanisms.
- B. India's modern anti-corruption architecture is structurally closer to Kautilya's control-based realism (statutory controls, vigilance machinery, Lokpal) than to Gandhi's exemplar-based idealism, yet invokes Gandhian language of integrity as a civilisational value in its public rhetoric.
- C. Kautilya's Arthashastra treats official corruption as an opportunity-driven structural phenomenon rather than a personal moral failing; the honey-and-poison passage (Kangle 2.9.32, cited in ARC Annexure-I(2)) argues that an official dealing with the king's money can no more avoid tasting it than a tongue can avoid tasting honey or poison placed on its surface.
- D. An anti-corruption regime built entirely on Kautilyan surveillance without any Gandhian or Vivekanandan appeal to service-motivation risks demoralising honest officials; the ARC cautions against excessive suspicion that discourages legitimate risk-taking.

Answer: D

Explanation: A regime built entirely on surveillance demoralises honest officials is the controlling principle. An anti-corruption regime built entirely on Kautilyan surveillance without any Gandhian or Vivekanandan appeal to service-motivation risks demoralising honest officials; the ARC cautions against excessive suspicion that discourages legitimate risk-taking. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 9

A welfare officer treats slum-resettlement beneficiaries with the same courtesy and procedural care as elite applicants, viewing service to the poorest as an expression of devotion rather than bureaucratic obligation. Which thinker's framework best explains this orientation? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Vivekananda applies Advaita's non-dual metaphysics (the self in all beings is one) to ground an ethic of service: serving the deprived is serving the divine, collapsing the sacred-secular distinction in public-service motivation through the concept of Daridra Narayana.
- B. Basava's principle Kayakave Kailasa holds that dignified, honest productive work is itself the divine abode; all honest labour, regardless of caste, carries equal spiritual and social worth, underpinning an anti-discrimination service ethic that anticipates Articles 17 and 23 of the Indian Constitution.
- C. Guru Nanak's Kirat Karo (earn through honest labour) and Vand Chhako (share with others) together model an ethic directly applicable to honest use of, and equitable sharing of, public resources; Kirat Karo opposes rent-seeking and corruption while Vand Chhako supports progressive, equity-oriented allocation.
- D. Vivekananda's Daridra Narayana, Basava's Kayaka and Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako all refuse a charity model of welfare (in which the giver is superior to the receiver) in favour of a dignity model (in which service to the deprived, or the deprived's own labour, carries equal spiritual and civic worth).

Answer: A

Explanation: Vivekananda's Practical Vedanta makes service a spiritual duty is the controlling principle. Vivekananda applies Advaita's non-dual metaphysics (the self in all beings is one) to ground an ethic of service: serving the deprived is serving the divine, collapsing the sacred-secular distinction in public-service motivation through the concept of Daridra Narayana. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 10

A training module tells officers that public service is a job like any other and that emotional engagement with beneficiaries is unprofessional. Which Indian philosophical framework directly challenges this detachment model? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Guru Nanak's Kirat Karo (earn through honest labour) and Vand Chhako (share with others) together model an ethic directly applicable to honest use of, and equitable sharing of, public resources; Kirat Karo opposes rent-seeking and corruption while Vand Chhako supports progressive, equity-oriented allocation.
- B. Vivekananda applies Advaita's non-dual metaphysics (the self in all beings is one) to ground an ethic of service: serving the deprived is serving the divine, collapsing the sacred-secular distinction in public-service motivation through the concept of Daridra Narayana.
- C. Vivekananda's Daridra Narayana, Basava's Kayaka and Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako all refuse a charity model of welfare (in which the giver is superior to the receiver) in favour of a dignity model (in which service to the deprived, or the deprived's own labour, carries equal spiritual and civic worth).
- D. Basava's principle Kayakave Kailasa holds that dignified, honest productive work is itself the divine abode; all honest labour, regardless of caste, carries equal spiritual and social worth, underpinning an anti-discrimination service ethic that anticipates Articles 17 and 23 of the Indian Constitution.

Answer: B

Explanation: Vivekananda's Practical Vedanta makes service a spiritual duty is the controlling principle.

Vivekananda applies Advaita's non-dual metaphysics (the self in all beings is one) to ground an ethic of service: serving the deprived is serving the divine, collapsing the sacred-secular distinction in public-service motivation through the concept of Daridra Narayana. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 11

A municipality assigns street sweepers the same benefits, protective equipment and recognition ceremonies as administrative staff, citing equal dignity of all public service. Which 12th-century thinker's ethical principle most directly supports this policy? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Vivekananda applies Advaita's non-dual metaphysics (the self in all beings is one) to ground an ethic of service: serving the deprived is serving the divine, collapsing the sacred-secular distinction in public-service motivation through the concept of Daridra Narayana.
- B. Guru Nanak's Kirat Karo (earn through honest labour) and Vand Chhako (share with others) together model an ethic directly applicable to honest use of, and equitable sharing of, public resources; Kirat Karo opposes rent-seeking and corruption while Vand Chhako supports progressive, equity-oriented allocation.
- C. Basava's principle Kayakave Kailasa holds that dignified, honest productive work is itself the divine abode; all honest labour, regardless of caste, carries equal spiritual and social worth, underpinning an anti-discrimination service ethic that anticipates Articles 17 and 23 of the Indian Constitution.
- D. Vivekananda's Daridra Narayana, Basava's Kayaka and Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako all refuse a charity model of welfare (in which the giver is superior to the receiver) in favour of a dignity model (in which service to the deprived, or the deprived's own labour, carries equal spiritual and civic worth).

Answer: C

Explanation: Basava's Kayaka assigns equal spiritual worth to all honest labour is the controlling principle.

Basava's principle Kayakave Kailasa holds that dignified, honest productive work is itself the divine abode; all honest labour, regardless of caste, carries equal spiritual and social worth, underpinning an anti-discrimination service ethic that anticipates Articles 17 and 23 of the Indian Constitution. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 12

A government office informally treats manual-labour roles as lower in dignity than desk-based roles, denying sanitation workers access to the common canteen. Which Indian moral thinker's core teaching does this workplace practice violate? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Guru Nanak's Kirat Karo (earn through honest labour) and Vand Chhako (share with others) together model an ethic directly applicable to honest use of, and equitable sharing of, public resources; Kirat Karo opposes rent-seeking and corruption while Vand Chhako supports progressive, equity-oriented allocation.
- B. Vivekananda's Daridra Narayana, Basava's Kayaka and Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako all refuse a charity model of welfare (in which the giver is superior to the receiver) in favour of a dignity model (in which service to the deprived, or the deprived's own labour, carries equal spiritual and civic worth).
- C. Vivekananda applies Advaita's non-dual metaphysics (the self in all beings is one) to ground an ethic of service: serving the deprived is serving the divine, collapsing the sacred-secular distinction in public-service motivation through the concept of Daridra Narayana.
- D. Basava's principle Kayakave Kailasa holds that dignified, honest productive work is itself the divine abode; all honest labour, regardless of caste, carries equal spiritual and social worth, underpinning an anti-discrimination service ethic that anticipates Articles 17 and 23 of the Indian Constitution.

Answer: D

Explanation: Basava's Kayaka assigns equal spiritual worth to all honest labour is the controlling principle.

Basava's principle Kayakave Kailasa holds that dignified, honest productive work is itself the divine abode; all honest labour, regardless of caste, carries equal spiritual and social worth, underpinning an anti-discrimination service ethic that anticipates Articles 17 and 23 of the Indian Constitution. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 13

A finance officer designs a budget that prioritises revenue through transparent tax collection and allocates a disproportionately higher share to healthcare in underserved districts. Which Indian thinker's paired principles most closely map to this honest-collection-plus-equitable-expenditure ethic? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Guru Nanak's Kirat Karo (earn through honest labour) and Vand Chhako (share with others) together model an ethic directly applicable to honest use of, and equitable sharing of, public resources; Kirat Karo opposes rent-seeking and corruption while Vand Chhako supports progressive, equity-oriented allocation.
- B. Vivekananda applies Advaita's non-dual metaphysics (the self in all beings is one) to ground an ethic of service: serving the deprived is serving the divine, collapsing the sacred-secular distinction in public-service motivation through the concept of Daridra Narayana.
- C. Basava's principle Kayakave Kailasa holds that dignified, honest productive work is itself the divine abode; all honest labour, regardless of caste, carries equal spiritual and social worth, underpinning an anti-discrimination service ethic that anticipates Articles 17 and 23 of the Indian Constitution.
- D. Vivekananda's Daridra Narayana, Basava's Kayaka and Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako all refuse a charity model of welfare (in which the giver is superior to the receiver) in favour of a dignity model (in which service to the deprived, or the deprived's own labour, carries equal spiritual and civic worth).

Answer: A

Explanation: Guru Nanak models honest earning plus equitable sharing is the controlling principle. Guru Nanak's Kirat Karo (earn through honest labour) and Vand Chhako (share with others) together model an ethic directly applicable to honest use of, and equitable sharing of, public resources; Kirat Karo opposes rent-seeking and corruption while Vand Chhako supports progressive, equity-oriented allocation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 14

A public servant earns an honest salary but opposes any redistribution of departmental resources toward weaker sections. Which component of the relevant Indian thinker's ethical framework is he partially embracing and which is he rejecting? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Basava's principle Kayakave Kailasa holds that dignified, honest productive work is itself the divine abode; all honest labour, regardless of caste, carries equal spiritual and social worth, underpinning an anti-discrimination service ethic that anticipates Articles 17 and 23 of the Indian Constitution.
- B. Guru Nanak's Kirat Karo (earn through honest labour) and Vand Chhako (share with others) together model an ethic directly applicable to honest use of, and equitable sharing of, public resources; Kirat Karo opposes rent-seeking and corruption while Vand Chhako supports progressive, equity-oriented allocation.
- C. Vivekananda's Daridra Narayana, Basava's Kayaka and Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako all refuse a charity model of welfare (in which the giver is superior to the receiver) in favour of a dignity model (in which service to the deprived, or the deprived's own labour, carries equal spiritual and civic worth).
- D. Vivekananda applies Advaita's non-dual metaphysics (the self in all beings is one) to ground an ethic of service: serving the deprived is serving the divine, collapsing the sacred-secular distinction in public-service motivation through the concept of Daridra Narayana.

Answer: B

Explanation: Guru Nanak models honest earning plus equitable sharing is the controlling principle. Guru Nanak's Kirat Karo (earn through honest labour) and Vand Chhako (share with others) together model an ethic directly applicable to honest use of, and equitable sharing of, public resources; Kirat Karo opposes rent-seeking and corruption while Vand Chhako supports progressive, equity-oriented allocation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 15

A welfare scheme requires beneficiaries to display their below-poverty-line status on public notice boards as a condition of receiving benefits. Which shared ethical principle among Vivekananda, Basava and Nanak does this stigmatising design violate? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Vivekananda applies Advaita's non-dual metaphysics (the self in all beings is one) to ground an ethic of service: serving the deprived is serving the divine, collapsing the sacred-secular distinction in public-service motivation through the concept of Daridra Narayana.
- B. Basava's principle Kayakave Kailasa holds that dignified, honest productive work is itself the divine abode; all honest labour, regardless of caste, carries equal spiritual and social worth, underpinning an anti-discrimination service ethic that anticipates Articles 17 and 23 of the Indian Constitution.
- C. Vivekananda's Daridra Narayana, Basava's Kayaka and Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako all refuse a charity model of welfare (in which the giver is superior to the receiver) in favour of a dignity model (in which service to the deprived, or the deprived's own labour, carries equal spiritual and civic worth).
- D. Guru Nanak's Kirat Karo (earn through honest labour) and Vand Chhako (share with others) together model an ethic directly applicable to honest use of, and equitable sharing of, public resources; Kirat Karo opposes rent-seeking and corruption while Vand Chhako supports progressive, equity-oriented allocation.

Answer: C

Explanation: All three refuse a charity model in favour of a dignity model is the controlling principle. Vivekananda's Daridra Narayana, Basava's Kayaka and Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako all refuse a charity model of welfare (in which the giver is superior to the receiver) in favour of a dignity model (in which service to the deprived, or the deprived's own labour, carries equal spiritual and civic worth). The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 16

A district redesigns its pension-delivery process so that elderly beneficiaries receive doorstep service without queuing or producing humiliating eligibility proof. Which convergence among three Indian thinkers is being operationalised? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Basava's principle Kayakave Kailasa holds that dignified, honest productive work is itself the divine abode; all honest labour, regardless of caste, carries equal spiritual and social worth, underpinning an anti-discrimination service ethic that anticipates Articles 17 and 23 of the Indian Constitution.
- B. Guru Nanak's Kirat Karo (earn through honest labour) and Vand Chhako (share with others) together model an ethic directly applicable to honest use of, and equitable sharing of, public resources; Kirat Karo opposes rent-seeking and corruption while Vand Chhako supports progressive, equity-oriented allocation.
- C. Vivekananda applies Advaita's non-dual metaphysics (the self in all beings is one) to ground an ethic of service: serving the deprived is serving the divine, collapsing the sacred-secular distinction in public-service motivation through the concept of Daridra Narayana.
- D. Vivekananda's Daridra Narayana, Basava's Kayaka and Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako all refuse a charity model of welfare (in which the giver is superior to the receiver) in favour of a dignity model (in which service to the deprived, or the deprived's own labour, carries equal spiritual and civic worth).

Answer: D

Explanation: All three refuse a charity model in favour of a dignity model is the controlling principle.

Vivekananda's Daridra Narayana, Basava's Kayaka and Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako all refuse a charity model of welfare (in which the giver is superior to the receiver) in favour of a dignity model (in which service to the deprived, or the deprived's own labour, carries equal spiritual and civic worth). The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 17

After food-safety violations at a single establishment, a district magistrate orders all restaurants in the city shut down for a month. A colleague suggests doing nothing because enforcement is unpopular. Which decision-procedure tests both responses against a principled standard? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Middle Path (Madhyama Pratipada) is best understood not as a static virtue of moderation but as a decision-procedure: before acting, test whether a contemplated administrative response is an over-reaction (excessive, punitive, populist crackdown) or an under-reaction (complacent inaction) and correct toward proportionality.
- B. The Eightfold Path's Right Action, Right Livelihood and Right Mindfulness map onto lawful conduct, honest occupation and self-aware decision-making in public administration; the Middle Path counsels against both reckless discretion and paralytic over-caution in administrative choice.
- C. Mahavir's Anekantavada (many-sidedness of truth) holds that no single perspective captures the whole truth; administratively, this operationalises listening to competing legitimate viewpoints before deciding, supporting multi-stakeholder consultation in policy design.
- D. The proportionality check, grounded in the Middle Path, prevents both populist crackdowns (over-reaction driven by short-term political pressure) and complacent inaction (under-reaction driven by risk-aversion or indifference); it maps directly onto the case-study method's proportionality test.

Answer: A

Explanation: Buddha's Middle Path is a decision-procedure, not a static virtue is the controlling principle. The

Middle Path (Madhyama Pratipada) is best understood not as a static virtue of moderation but as a decision-procedure: before acting, test whether a contemplated administrative response is an over-reaction (excessive, punitive, populist crackdown) or an under-reaction (complacent inaction) and correct toward proportionality. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 18

A civil servant facing a land dispute is told to 'be balanced' but receives no operational guidance on what balance means. Which Indian philosophical framework converts balance from a vague instruction into a testable procedure? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Mahavir's Anekantavada (many-sidedness of truth) holds that no single perspective captures the whole truth; administratively, this operationalises listening to competing legitimate viewpoints before deciding, supporting multi-stakeholder consultation in policy design.
- B. The Middle Path (Madhyama Pratipada) is best understood not as a static virtue of moderation but as a decision-procedure: before acting, test whether a contemplated administrative response is an over-reaction (excessive, punitive, populist crackdown) or an under-reaction (complacent inaction) and correct toward proportionality.
- C. The proportionality check, grounded in the Middle Path, prevents both populist crackdowns (over-reaction driven by short-term political pressure) and complacent inaction (under-reaction driven by risk-aversion or indifference); it maps directly onto the case-study method's proportionality test.
- D. The Eightfold Path's Right Action, Right Livelihood and Right Mindfulness map onto lawful conduct, honest occupation and self-aware decision-making in public administration; the Middle Path counsels against both reckless discretion and paralytic over-caution in administrative choice.

Answer: B

Explanation: Buddha's Middle Path is a decision-procedure, not a static virtue is the controlling principle. The Middle Path (Madhyama Pratipada) is best understood not as a static virtue of moderation but as a decision-procedure: before acting, test whether a contemplated administrative response is an over-reaction (excessive, punitive, populist crackdown) or an under-reaction (complacent inaction) and correct toward proportionality. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 19

A revenue officer mindfully reviews her own assumptions before rejecting a tribal land-claim application, ensuring that her decision is based on evidence rather than inherited prejudice. Which element of the Eightfold Path is she applying to her administrative role? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Middle Path (Madhyama Pratipada) is best understood not as a static virtue of moderation but as a decision-procedure: before acting, test whether a contemplated administrative response is an over-reaction (excessive, punitive, populist crackdown) or an under-reaction (complacent inaction) and correct toward proportionality.
- B. Mahavir's Anekantavada (many-sidedness of truth) holds that no single perspective captures the whole truth; administratively, this operationalises listening to competing legitimate viewpoints before deciding, supporting multi-stakeholder consultation in policy design.
- C. The Eightfold Path's Right Action, Right Livelihood and Right Mindfulness map onto lawful conduct, honest occupation and self-aware decision-making in public administration; the Middle Path counsels against both reckless discretion and paralytic over-caution in administrative choice.
- D. The proportionality check, grounded in the Middle Path, prevents both populist crackdowns (over-reaction driven by short-term political pressure) and complacent inaction (under-reaction driven by risk-aversion or indifference); it maps directly onto the case-study method's proportionality test.

Answer: C

Explanation: The Eightfold Path maps to official conduct standards is the controlling principle. The Eightfold Path's Right Action, Right Livelihood and Right Mindfulness map onto lawful conduct, honest occupation and self-aware decision-making in public administration; the Middle Path counsels against both reckless discretion and paralytic over-caution in administrative choice. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 20

An officer accepts a posting in a department whose revenue-generation methods he considers unethical but takes no action to seek a transfer or raise the concern internally. Which Eightfold Path component is relevant to evaluating his occupational choice? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Mahavir's Anekantavada (many-sidedness of truth) holds that no single perspective captures the whole truth; administratively, this operationalises listening to competing legitimate viewpoints before deciding, supporting multi-stakeholder consultation in policy design.
- B. The proportionality check, grounded in the Middle Path, prevents both populist crackdowns (over-reaction driven by short-term political pressure) and complacent inaction (under-reaction driven by risk-aversion or indifference); it maps directly onto the case-study method's proportionality test.
- C. The Middle Path (Madhyama Pratipada) is best understood not as a static virtue of moderation but as a decision-procedure: before acting, test whether a contemplated administrative response is an over-reaction (excessive, punitive, populist crackdown) or an under-reaction (complacent inaction) and correct toward proportionality.
- D. The Eightfold Path's Right Action, Right Livelihood and Right Mindfulness map onto lawful conduct, honest occupation and self-aware decision-making in public administration; the Middle Path counsels against both reckless discretion and paralytic over-caution in administrative choice.

Answer: D

Explanation: The Eightfold Path maps to official conduct standards is the controlling principle. The Eightfold Path's Right Action, Right Livelihood and Right Mindfulness map onto lawful conduct, honest occupation and self-aware decision-making in public administration; the Middle Path counsels against both reckless discretion and paralytic over-caution in administrative choice. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 21

A district collector mediating a land dispute between a tribal community, an industrial developer and an environmental group deliberately holds separate hearings with each before synthesising a decision. Which Indian thinker's epistemological doctrine supports this process? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Mahavir's Anekantavada (many-sidedness of truth) holds that no single perspective captures the whole truth; administratively, this operationalises listening to competing legitimate viewpoints before deciding, supporting multi-stakeholder consultation in policy design.
- B. The Middle Path (Madhyama Pratipada) is best understood not as a static virtue of moderation but as a decision-procedure: before acting, test whether a contemplated administrative response is an over-reaction (excessive, punitive, populist crackdown) or an under-reaction (complacent inaction) and correct toward proportionality.
- C. The Eightfold Path's Right Action, Right Livelihood and Right Mindfulness map onto lawful conduct, honest occupation and self-aware decision-making in public administration; the Middle Path counsels against both reckless discretion and paralytic over-caution in administrative choice.
- D. The proportionality check, grounded in the Middle Path, prevents both populist crackdowns (over-reaction driven by short-term political pressure) and complacent inaction (under-reaction driven by risk-aversion or indifference); it maps directly onto the case-study method's proportionality test.

Answer: A

Explanation: Mahavir's Anekantavada supports multi-stakeholder consultation is the controlling principle. Mahavir's Anekantavada (many-sidedness of truth) holds that no single perspective captures the whole truth; administratively, this operationalises listening to competing legitimate viewpoints before deciding, supporting multi-stakeholder consultation in policy design. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 22

A policymaker dismisses minority objections to a highway project, saying the majority benefit is the only relevant perspective. Which Jain doctrine warns against this single-perspective approach? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Eightfold Path's Right Action, Right Livelihood and Right Mindfulness map onto lawful conduct, honest occupation and self-aware decision-making in public administration; the Middle Path counsels against both reckless discretion and paralytic over-caution in administrative choice.
- B. Mahavir's Anekantavada (many-sidedness of truth) holds that no single perspective captures the whole truth; administratively, this operationalises listening to competing legitimate viewpoints before deciding, supporting multi-stakeholder consultation in policy design.
- C. The proportionality check, grounded in the Middle Path, prevents both populist crackdowns (over-reaction driven by short-term political pressure) and complacent inaction (under-reaction driven by risk-aversion or indifference); it maps directly onto the case-study method's proportionality test.
- D. The Middle Path (Madhyama Pratipada) is best understood not as a static virtue of moderation but as a decision-procedure: before acting, test whether a contemplated administrative response is an over-reaction (excessive, punitive, populist crackdown) or an under-reaction (complacent inaction) and correct toward proportionality.

Answer: B

Explanation: Mahavir's Anekantavada supports multi-stakeholder consultation is the controlling principle.

Mahavir's Anekantavada (many-sidedness of truth) holds that no single perspective captures the whole truth; administratively, this operationalises listening to competing legitimate viewpoints before deciding, supporting multi-stakeholder consultation in policy design. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 23

After a viral social-media outrage, a state government demolishes an entire market complex for one building violation instead of issuing targeted notices. Which ethical decision-procedure would have prevented this disproportionate response? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Middle Path (Madhyama Pratipada) is best understood not as a static virtue of moderation but as a decision-procedure: before acting, test whether a contemplated administrative response is an over-reaction (excessive, punitive, populist crackdown) or an under-reaction (complacent inaction) and correct toward proportionality.
- B. The Eightfold Path's Right Action, Right Livelihood and Right Mindfulness map onto lawful conduct, honest occupation and self-aware decision-making in public administration; the Middle Path counsels against both reckless discretion and paralytic over-caution in administrative choice.
- C. The proportionality check, grounded in the Middle Path, prevents both populist crackdowns (over-reaction driven by short-term political pressure) and complacent inaction (under-reaction driven by risk-aversion or indifference); it maps directly onto the case-study method's proportionality test.
- D. Mahavir's Anekantavada (many-sidedness of truth) holds that no single perspective captures the whole truth; administratively, this operationalises listening to competing legitimate viewpoints before deciding, supporting multi-stakeholder consultation in policy design.

Answer: C

Explanation: Proportionality prevents both populist crackdowns and inaction is the controlling principle. The proportionality check, grounded in the Middle Path, prevents both populist crackdowns (over-reaction driven by short-term political pressure) and complacent inaction (under-reaction driven by risk-aversion or indifference); it maps directly onto the case-study method's proportionality test. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 24

A sub-divisional magistrate knows that illegal sand mining is occurring but takes no action because previous enforcement led to political backlash. Which ethical framework identifies this as the opposite extreme that is equally problematic? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Eightfold Path's Right Action, Right Livelihood and Right Mindfulness map onto lawful conduct, honest occupation and self-aware decision-making in public administration; the Middle Path counsels against both reckless discretion and paralytic over-caution in administrative choice.
- B. Mahavir's Anekantavada (many-sidedness of truth) holds that no single perspective captures the whole truth; administratively, this operationalises listening to competing legitimate viewpoints before deciding, supporting multi-stakeholder consultation in policy design.
- C. The Middle Path (Madhyama Pratipada) is best understood not as a static virtue of moderation but as a decision-procedure: before acting, test whether a contemplated administrative response is an over-reaction (excessive, punitive, populist crackdown) or an under-reaction (complacent inaction) and correct toward proportionality.
- D. The proportionality check, grounded in the Middle Path, prevents both populist crackdowns (over-reaction driven by short-term political pressure) and complacent inaction (under-reaction driven by risk-aversion or indifference); it maps directly onto the case-study method's proportionality test.

Answer: D

Explanation: Proportionality prevents both populist crackdowns and inaction is the controlling principle. The proportionality check, grounded in the Middle Path, prevents both populist crackdowns (over-reaction driven by short-term political pressure) and complacent inaction (under-reaction driven by risk-aversion or indifference); it maps directly onto the case-study method's proportionality test. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 25

A chief minister pressures a district magistrate to bypass environmental-clearance procedures for a politically important project. The officer insists on following the statutory process despite the pressure. Which concept from which Indian thinker grounds her refusal? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Ambedkar invoked constitutional morality in the Constituent Assembly on 4 November 1948, quoting historian George Grote: a paramount reverence for the forms of the Constitution, enforcing obedience to authority acting under and within these forms yet combined with the habit of open speech and unrestrained censure of those very authorities as to all their public acts.
- B. In his Constituent Assembly speech of 25 November 1949, Ambedkar warned that India was entering a life of contradictions: political equality (one person, one vote) alongside continuing social and economic inequality; he cautioned that this contradiction must be removed at the earliest or those suffering from inequality will blow up the structure of political democracy.
- C. Ambedkar named fraternity - a sense of common brotherhood of all Indians - as necessary because liberty and equality without fraternity would need a policeman to enforce them; fraternity is what makes constitutional values self-sustaining rather than externally coerced.
- D. Ambedkar's design philosophy embedded minority and SC-ST safeguards, judicial review and the fundamental-rights chapter precisely because he distrusted majoritarian goodwill alone to protect equality; durable ethical commitments need institutional containers, not moral exhortation alone.

Answer: A

Explanation: Ambedkar's constitutional morality demands reverence for constitutional forms is the controlling principle. Ambedkar invoked constitutional morality in the Constituent Assembly on 4 November 1948, quoting historian George Grote: a paramount reverence for the forms of the Constitution, enforcing obedience to authority acting under and within these forms yet combined with the habit of open speech and unrestrained censure of those very authorities as to all their public acts. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 26

A citizen argues that constitutional morality means blind obedience to any law regardless of its content. Which dimension of Ambedkar's formulation, drawn from Grote, includes the right of unrestrained censure and thus contradicts this reading? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Ambedkar named fraternity - a sense of common brotherhood of all Indians - as necessary because liberty and equality without fraternity would need a policeman to enforce them; fraternity is what makes constitutional values self-sustaining rather than externally coerced.
- B. Ambedkar invoked constitutional morality in the Constituent Assembly on 4 November 1948, quoting historian George Grote: a paramount reverence for the forms of the Constitution, enforcing obedience to authority acting under and within these forms yet combined with the habit of open speech and unrestrained censure of those very authorities as to all their public acts.
- C. Ambedkar's design philosophy embedded minority and SC-ST safeguards, judicial review and the fundamental-rights chapter precisely because he distrusted majoritarian goodwill alone to protect equality; durable ethical commitments need institutional containers, not moral exhortation alone.
- D. In his Constituent Assembly speech of 25 November 1949, Ambedkar warned that India was entering a life of contradictions: political equality (one person, one vote) alongside continuing social and economic inequality; he cautioned that this contradiction must be removed at the earliest or those suffering from inequality will blow up the structure of political democracy.

Answer: B

Explanation: Ambedkar's constitutional morality demands reverence for constitutional forms is the controlling principle. Ambedkar invoked constitutional morality in the Constituent Assembly on 4 November 1948, quoting historian George Grote: a paramount reverence for the forms of the Constitution, enforcing obedience to authority acting under and within these forms yet combined with the habit of open speech and unrestrained censure of those very authorities as to all their public acts. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 27

A district with universal adult franchise still has female literacy below 30 per cent and landless labourers comprising 60 per cent of the population. A civil servant designing welfare interventions invokes which Indian thinker's specific warning to justify targeted affirmative action? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Ambedkar invoked constitutional morality in the Constituent Assembly on 4 November 1948, quoting historian George Grote: a paramount reverence for the forms of the Constitution, enforcing obedience to authority acting under and within these forms yet combined with the habit of open speech and unrestrained censure of those very authorities as to all their public acts.
- B. Ambedkar named fraternity - a sense of common brotherhood of all Indians - as necessary because liberty and equality without fraternity would need a policeman to enforce them; fraternity is what makes constitutional values self-sustaining rather than externally coerced.
- C. In his Constituent Assembly speech of 25 November 1949, Ambedkar warned that India was entering a life of contradictions: political equality (one person, one vote) alongside continuing social and economic inequality; he cautioned that this contradiction must be removed at the earliest or those suffering from inequality will blow up the structure of political democracy.
- D. Ambedkar's design philosophy embedded minority and SC-ST safeguards, judicial review and the fundamental-rights chapter precisely because he distrusted majoritarian goodwill alone to protect equality; durable ethical commitments need institutional containers, not moral exhortation alone.

Answer: C

Explanation: Ambedkar warned of a life of contradictions is the controlling principle. In his Constituent Assembly speech of 25 November 1949, Ambedkar warned that India was entering a life of contradictions: political equality (one person, one vote) alongside continuing social and economic inequality; he cautioned that this contradiction must be

removed at the earliest or those suffering from inequality will blow up the structure of political democracy. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 28

A colleague argues that political equality through elections is sufficient for democracy and that social inequality is a private matter. Which specific constitutional-assembly speech refutes this claim and identifies the resulting risk? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Ambedkar named fraternity - a sense of common brotherhood of all Indians - as necessary because liberty and equality without fraternity would need a policeman to enforce them; fraternity is what makes constitutional values self-sustaining rather than externally coerced.
- B. Ambedkar's design philosophy embedded minority and SC-ST safeguards, judicial review and the fundamental-rights chapter precisely because he distrusted majoritarian goodwill alone to protect equality; durable ethical commitments need institutional containers, not moral exhortation alone.
- C. Ambedkar invoked constitutional morality in the Constituent Assembly on 4 November 1948, quoting historian George Grote: a paramount reverence for the forms of the Constitution, enforcing obedience to authority acting under and within these forms yet combined with the habit of open speech and unrestrained censure of those very authorities as to all their public acts.
- D. In his Constituent Assembly speech of 25 November 1949, Ambedkar warned that India was entering a life of contradictions: political equality (one person, one vote) alongside continuing social and economic inequality; he cautioned that this contradiction must be removed at the earliest or those suffering from inequality will blow up the structure of political democracy.

Answer: D

Explanation: Ambedkar warned of a life of contradictions is the controlling principle. In his Constituent Assembly speech of 25 November 1949, Ambedkar warned that India was entering a life of contradictions: political equality (one person, one vote) alongside continuing social and economic inequality; he cautioned that this contradiction must be removed at the earliest or those suffering from inequality will blow up the structure of political democracy. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 29

A state enforces anti-discrimination laws strictly but communities remain deeply segregated and hostile. A social reformer argues that legal enforcement alone is insufficient without a shared sense of belonging. Which Ambedkar concept does the reformer invoke? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Ambedkar named fraternity - a sense of common brotherhood of all Indians - as necessary because liberty and equality without fraternity would need a policeman to enforce them; fraternity is what makes constitutional values self-sustaining rather than externally coerced.
- B. Ambedkar invoked constitutional morality in the Constituent Assembly on 4 November 1948, quoting historian George Grote: a paramount reverence for the forms of the Constitution, enforcing obedience to authority acting under and within these forms yet combined with the habit of open speech and unrestrained censure of those very authorities as to all their public acts.
- C. In his Constituent Assembly speech of 25 November 1949, Ambedkar warned that India was entering a life of contradictions: political equality (one person, one vote) alongside continuing social and economic inequality; he cautioned that this contradiction must be removed at the earliest or those suffering from inequality will blow up the structure of political democracy.
- D. Ambedkar's design philosophy embedded minority and SC-ST safeguards, judicial review and the fundamental-rights chapter precisely because he distrusted majoritarian goodwill alone to protect equality; durable ethical commitments need institutional containers, not moral exhortation alone.

Answer: A

Explanation: Fraternity makes constitutional values self-sustaining is the controlling principle. Ambedkar named fraternity - a sense of common brotherhood of all Indians - as necessary because liberty and equality without fraternity

would need a policeman to enforce them; fraternity is what makes constitutional values self-sustaining rather than externally coerced. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 30

A civil servant wonders why high rates of prosecution under atrocity-prevention laws have not reduced caste violence. Which Ambedkar principle explains why legal coercion without underlying social solidarity is structurally fragile? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. In his Constituent Assembly speech of 25 November 1949, Ambedkar warned that India was entering a life of contradictions: political equality (one person, one vote) alongside continuing social and economic inequality; he cautioned that this contradiction must be removed at the earliest or those suffering from inequality will blow up the structure of political democracy.
- B. Ambedkar named fraternity - a sense of common brotherhood of all Indians - as necessary because liberty and equality without fraternity would need a policeman to enforce them; fraternity is what makes constitutional values self-sustaining rather than externally coerced.
- C. Ambedkar's design philosophy embedded minority and SC-ST safeguards, judicial review and the fundamental-rights chapter precisely because he distrusted majoritarian goodwill alone to protect equality; durable ethical commitments need institutional containers, not moral exhortation alone.
- D. Ambedkar invoked constitutional morality in the Constituent Assembly on 4 November 1948, quoting historian George Grote: a paramount reverence for the forms of the Constitution, enforcing obedience to authority acting under and within these forms yet combined with the habit of open speech and unrestrained censure of those very authorities as to all their public acts.

Answer: B

Explanation: Fraternity makes constitutional values self-sustaining is the controlling principle. Ambedkar named fraternity - a sense of common brotherhood of all Indians - as necessary because liberty and equality without fraternity would need a policeman to enforce them; fraternity is what makes constitutional values self-sustaining rather than externally coerced. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 31

A parliamentary majority proposes to amend a fundamental right that protects religious minorities. An opposition member argues that the basic-structure doctrine exists precisely for such situations. Which Indian thinker's design philosophy does this argument reflect? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Ambedkar invoked constitutional morality in the Constituent Assembly on 4 November 1948, quoting historian George Grote: a paramount reverence for the forms of the Constitution, enforcing obedience to authority acting under and within these forms yet combined with the habit of open speech and unrestrained censure of those very authorities as to all their public acts.
- B. In his Constituent Assembly speech of 25 November 1949, Ambedkar warned that India was entering a life of contradictions: political equality (one person, one vote) alongside continuing social and economic inequality; he cautioned that this contradiction must be removed at the earliest or those suffering from inequality will blow up the structure of political democracy.
- C. Ambedkar's design philosophy embedded minority and SC-ST safeguards, judicial review and the fundamental-rights chapter precisely because he distrusted majoritarian goodwill alone to protect equality; durable ethical commitments need institutional containers, not moral exhortation alone.
- D. Ambedkar named fraternity - a sense of common brotherhood of all Indians - as necessary because liberty and equality without fraternity would need a policeman to enforce them; fraternity is what makes constitutional values self-sustaining rather than externally coerced.

Answer: C

Explanation: Institutional safeguards embed distrust of majoritarian goodwill alone is the controlling principle. Ambedkar's design philosophy embedded minority and SC-ST safeguards, judicial review and the fundamental-rights chapter precisely because he distrusted majoritarian goodwill alone to protect equality; durable ethical commitments need institutional containers, not moral exhortation alone. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 32

A colleague says India should trust the goodwill of the majority to protect minority rights without needing constitutional safeguards. Which Indian thinker's explicit design rationale in the Constituent Assembly contradicts this position? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. In his Constituent Assembly speech of 25 November 1949, Ambedkar warned that India was entering a life of contradictions: political equality (one person, one vote) alongside continuing social and economic inequality; he cautioned that this contradiction must be removed at the earliest or those suffering from inequality will blow up the structure of political democracy.
- B. Ambedkar named fraternity - a sense of common brotherhood of all Indians - as necessary because liberty and equality without fraternity would need a policeman to enforce them; fraternity is what makes constitutional values self-sustaining rather than externally coerced.
- C. Ambedkar invoked constitutional morality in the Constituent Assembly on 4 November 1948, quoting historian George Grote: a paramount reverence for the forms of the Constitution, enforcing obedience to authority acting under and within these forms yet combined with the habit of open speech and unrestrained censure of those very authorities as to all their public acts.
- D. Ambedkar's design philosophy embedded minority and SC-ST safeguards, judicial review and the fundamental-rights chapter precisely because he distrusted majoritarian goodwill alone to protect equality; durable ethical commitments need institutional containers, not moral exhortation alone.

Answer: D

Explanation: Institutional safeguards embed distrust of majoritarian goodwill alone is the controlling principle. Ambedkar's design philosophy embedded minority and SC-ST safeguards, judicial review and the fundamental-rights chapter precisely because he distrusted majoritarian goodwill alone to protect equality; durable ethical commitments need institutional containers, not moral exhortation alone. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 33

A candidate quotes 'pleasure without conscience' from Gandhi and is challenged by a peer who insists the ARC says 'leisure without conscience'. Which source caveat resolves this and what is the defensible exam approach? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Gandhi's Seven Social Sins as printed in ARC Box 2.8 include 'leisure without conscience'; however, the original Young India note of 22 October 1925 reads 'pleasure without conscience'. Gandhi received the list from a correspondent and published it without claiming personal authorship. Use the ARC wording in ARC-cited answers but note the discrepancy.
- B. Basava (12th century, Kalachuri kingdom under Bijjala) is associated with the Anubhava Mantapa, an assembly of Lingayat sharanas for spiritual and social discourse open across caste and gender; it should be presented as a tradition-attested assembly, not as a securely dated founded institution, and the popular 'first parliament of the world' formulation must be avoided.
- C. Guru Nanak's three pillars - Naam Japna, Kirat Karo, Vand Chhako - have a firm scriptural basis in the Guru Granth Sahib (Angs 8 and 1245), but the 'three pillars' phrasing itself is later pedagogical packaging, not a verbatim triad of Guru Nanak's own words.
- D. The 2025 GS-IV Q3(c) Vivekananda quotation on the strength of a society being in the morality of its people is attributed by UPSC but is not traceable to the Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda; it should be presented with an 'attributed by UPSC' caveat rather than as a verified primary-source quotation.

Answer: A

Explanation: Gandhi's Seven Social Sins: leisure versus pleasure wording split is the controlling principle. Gandhi's Seven Social Sins as printed in ARC Box 2.8 include 'leisure without conscience'; however, the original Young India note of 22 October 1925 reads 'pleasure without conscience'. Gandhi received the list from a correspondent and published it without claiming personal authorship. Use the ARC wording in ARC-cited answers but note the discrepancy. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 34

An ethics training module attributes the Seven Social Sins entirely to Gandhi's original formulation. Which provenance correction should the module make to be historically accurate? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Guru Nanak's three pillars - Naam Japna, Kirat Karo, Vand Chhako - have a firm scriptural basis in the Guru Granth Sahib (Angs 8 and 1245), but the 'three pillars' phrasing itself is later pedagogical packaging, not a verbatim triad of Guru Nanak's own words.
- B. Gandhi's Seven Social Sins as printed in ARC Box 2.8 include 'leisure without conscience'; however, the original Young India note of 22 October 1925 reads 'pleasure without conscience'. Gandhi received the list from a correspondent and published it without claiming personal authorship. Use the ARC wording in ARC-cited answers but note the discrepancy.
- C. The 2025 GS-IV Q3(c) Vivekananda quotation on the strength of a society being in the morality of its people is attributed by UPSC but is not traceable to the Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda; it should be presented with an 'attributed by UPSC' caveat rather than as a verified primary-source quotation.
- D. Basava (12th century, Kalachuri kingdom under Bijjala) is associated with the Anubhava Mantapa, an assembly of Lingayat sharanas for spiritual and social discourse open across caste and gender; it should be presented as a tradition-attested assembly, not as a securely dated founded institution, and the popular 'first parliament of the world' formulation must be avoided.

Answer: B

Explanation: Gandhi's Seven Social Sins: leisure versus pleasure wording split is the controlling principle. Gandhi's Seven Social Sins as printed in ARC Box 2.8 include 'leisure without conscience'; however, the original Young India note of 22 October 1925 reads 'pleasure without conscience'. Gandhi received the list from a correspondent and published it without claiming personal authorship. Use the ARC wording in ARC-cited answers but note the discrepancy. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 35

A candidate writes that Basava 'established the world's first parliament in the 12th century.' Which specific attribution caution applies and how should the claim be restated for exam safety? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Gandhi's Seven Social Sins as printed in ARC Box 2.8 include 'leisure without conscience'; however, the original Young India note of 22 October 1925 reads 'pleasure without conscience'. Gandhi received the list from a correspondent and published it without claiming personal authorship. Use the ARC wording in ARC-cited answers but note the discrepancy.
- B. Guru Nanak's three pillars - Naam Japna, Kirat Karo, Vand Chhako - have a firm scriptural basis in the Guru Granth Sahib (Angs 8 and 1245), but the 'three pillars' phrasing itself is later pedagogical packaging, not a verbatim triad of Guru Nanak's own words.
- C. Basava (12th century, Kalachuri kingdom under Bijjala) is associated with the Anubhava Mantapa, an assembly of Lingayat sharanas for spiritual and social discourse open across caste and gender; it should be presented as a tradition-attested assembly, not as a securely dated founded institution, and the popular 'first parliament of the world' formulation must be avoided.
- D. The 2025 GS-IV Q3(c) Vivekananda quotation on the strength of a society being in the morality of its people is attributed by UPSC but is not traceable to the Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda; it should be presented with an 'attributed by UPSC' caveat rather than as a verified primary-source quotation.

Answer: C

Explanation: Anubhava Mantapa is tradition-attested, not securely dated is the controlling principle. Basava (12th century, Kalachuri kingdom under Bijjala) is associated with the Anubhava Mantapa, an assembly of Lingayat sharanas for spiritual and social discourse open across caste and gender; it should be presented as a tradition-attested assembly, not as a securely dated founded institution, and the popular 'first parliament of the world' formulation must be avoided. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 36

A textbook describes the Anubhava Mantapa as a 'securely dated democratic institution founded in 1160 CE.' Which qualification is needed to make this historically defensible? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Guru Nanak's three pillars - Naam Japna, Kirat Karo, Vand Chhako - have a firm scriptural basis in the Guru Granth Sahib (Angs 8 and 1245), but the 'three pillars' phrasing itself is later pedagogical packaging, not a verbatim triad of Guru Nanak's own words.
- B. The 2025 GS-IV Q3(c) Vivekananda quotation on the strength of a society being in the morality of its people is attributed by UPSC but is not traceable to the Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda; it should be presented with an 'attributed by UPSC' caveat rather than as a verified primary-source quotation.
- C. Gandhi's Seven Social Sins as printed in ARC Box 2.8 include 'leisure without conscience'; however, the original Young India note of 22 October 1925 reads 'pleasure without conscience'. Gandhi received the list from a correspondent and published it without claiming personal authorship. Use the ARC wording in ARC-cited answers but note the discrepancy.
- D. Basava (12th century, Kalachuri kingdom under Bijjala) is associated with the Anubhava Mantapa, an assembly of Lingayat sharanas for spiritual and social discourse open across caste and gender; it should be presented as a tradition-attested assembly, not as a securely dated founded institution, and the popular 'first parliament of the world' formulation must be avoided.

Answer: D

Explanation: Anubhava Mantapa is tradition-attested, not securely dated is the controlling principle. Basava (12th century, Kalachuri kingdom under Bijjala) is associated with the Anubhava Mantapa, an assembly of Lingayat sharanas for spiritual and social discourse open across caste and gender; it should be presented as a tradition-attested assembly, not as a securely dated founded institution, and the popular 'first parliament of the world' formulation must be avoided.

formulation must be avoided. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 37

A candidate attributes the exact phrase 'three pillars' to Guru Nanak as a direct quotation from the Guru Granth Sahib. Which provenance correction is needed? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Guru Nanak's three pillars - Naam Japna, Kirat Karo, Vand Chhako - have a firm scriptural basis in the Guru Granth Sahib (Angs 8 and 1245), but the 'three pillars' phrasing itself is later pedagogical packaging, not a verbatim triad of Guru Nanak's own words.
- B. Gandhi's Seven Social Sins as printed in ARC Box 2.8 include 'leisure without conscience'; however, the original Young India note of 22 October 1925 reads 'pleasure without conscience'. Gandhi received the list from a correspondent and published it without claiming personal authorship. Use the ARC wording in ARC-cited answers but note the discrepancy.
- C. Basava (12th century, Kalachuri kingdom under Bijjala) is associated with the Anubhava Mantapa, an assembly of Lingayat sharanas for spiritual and social discourse open across caste and gender; it should be presented as a tradition-attested assembly, not as a securely dated founded institution, and the popular 'first parliament of the world' formulation must be avoided.
- D. The 2025 GS-IV Q3(c) Vivekananda quotation on the strength of a society being in the morality of its people is attributed by UPSC but is not traceable to the Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda; it should be presented with an 'attributed by UPSC' caveat rather than as a verified primary-source quotation.

Answer: A

Explanation: **Guru Nanak's three pillars is later pedagogical packaging** is the controlling principle. Guru Nanak's three pillars - Naam Japna, Kirat Karo, Vand Chhako - have a firm scriptural basis in the Guru Granth Sahib (Angs 8 and 1245), but the 'three pillars' phrasing itself is later pedagogical packaging, not a verbatim triad of Guru Nanak's own words. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 38

An examiner asks whether Guru Nanak explicitly formulated a three-part ethical system. How should a candidate frame the answer to use the content accurately without fabricating a primary-source quotation? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Basava (12th century, Kalachuri kingdom under Bijjala) is associated with the Anubhava Mantapa, an assembly of Lingayat sharanas for spiritual and social discourse open across caste and gender; it should be presented as a tradition-attested assembly, not as a securely dated founded institution, and the popular 'first parliament of the world' formulation must be avoided.
- B. Guru Nanak's three pillars - Naam Japna, Kirat Karo, Vand Chhako - have a firm scriptural basis in the Guru Granth Sahib (Angs 8 and 1245), but the 'three pillars' phrasing itself is later pedagogical packaging, not a verbatim triad of Guru Nanak's own words.
- C. The 2025 GS-IV Q3(c) Vivekananda quotation on the strength of a society being in the morality of its people is attributed by UPSC but is not traceable to the Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda; it should be presented with an 'attributed by UPSC' caveat rather than as a verified primary-source quotation.
- D. Gandhi's Seven Social Sins as printed in ARC Box 2.8 include 'leisure without conscience'; however, the original Young India note of 22 October 1925 reads 'pleasure without conscience'. Gandhi received the list from a correspondent and published it without claiming personal authorship. Use the ARC wording in ARC-cited answers but note the discrepancy.

Answer: B

Explanation: **Guru Nanak's three pillars is later pedagogical packaging** is the controlling principle. Guru Nanak's three pillars - Naam Japna, Kirat Karo, Vand Chhako - have a firm scriptural basis in the Guru Granth Sahib (Angs 8 and 1245), but the 'three pillars' phrasing itself is later pedagogical packaging, not a verbatim triad of Guru Nanak's own words. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 39

A candidate writing a practice answer cites 'as Vivekananda said in his Complete Works' for the 2025 Q3(c) quotation. Which correction preserves exam utility without fabricating a primary source? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

A. Gandhi's Seven Social Sins as printed in ARC Box 2.8 include 'leisure without conscience'; however, the original Young India note of 22 October 1925 reads 'pleasure without conscience'. Gandhi received the list from a correspondent and published it without claiming personal authorship. Use the ARC wording in ARC-cited answers but note the discrepancy.

B. Basava (12th century, Kalachuri kingdom under Bijjala) is associated with the Anubhava Mantapa, an assembly of Lingayat sharanas for spiritual and social discourse open across caste and gender; it should be presented as a tradition-attested assembly, not as a securely dated founded institution, and the popular 'first parliament of the world' formulation must be avoided.

C. The 2025 GS-IV Q3(c) Vivekananda quotation on the strength of a society being in the morality of its people is attributed by UPSC but is not traceable to the Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda; it should be presented with an 'attributed by UPSC' caveat rather than as a verified primary-source quotation.

D. Guru Nanak's three pillars - Naam Japna, Kirat Karo, Vand Chhako - have a firm scriptural basis in the Guru Granth Sahib (Angs 8 and 1245), but the 'three pillars' phrasing itself is later pedagogical packaging, not a verbatim triad of Guru Nanak's own words.

Answer: C

Explanation: **2025 Vivekananda quotation not traceable to Complete Works** is the controlling principle. The 2025 GS-IV Q3(c) Vivekananda quotation on the strength of a society being in the morality of its people is attributed by UPSC but is not traceable to the Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda; it should be presented with an 'attributed by UPSC' caveat rather than as a verified primary-source quotation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 40

A coaching institute's handout lists the 2025 Q3(c) line as Volume III of the Complete Works. Which verification step should a student take before accepting this attribution? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

A. Basava (12th century, Kalachuri kingdom under Bijjala) is associated with the Anubhava Mantapa, an assembly of Lingayat sharanas for spiritual and social discourse open across caste and gender; it should be presented as a tradition-attested assembly, not as a securely dated founded institution, and the popular 'first parliament of the world' formulation must be avoided.

B. Guru Nanak's three pillars - Naam Japna, Kirat Karo, Vand Chhako - have a firm scriptural basis in the Guru Granth Sahib (Angs 8 and 1245), but the 'three pillars' phrasing itself is later pedagogical packaging, not a verbatim triad of Guru Nanak's own words.

C. Gandhi's Seven Social Sins as printed in ARC Box 2.8 include 'leisure without conscience'; however, the original Young India note of 22 October 1925 reads 'pleasure without conscience'. Gandhi received the list from a correspondent and published it without claiming personal authorship. Use the ARC wording in ARC-cited answers but note the discrepancy.

D. The 2025 GS-IV Q3(c) Vivekananda quotation on the strength of a society being in the morality of its people is attributed by UPSC but is not traceable to the Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda; it should be presented with an 'attributed by UPSC' caveat rather than as a verified primary-source quotation.

Answer: D

Explanation: **2025 Vivekananda quotation not traceable to Complete Works** is the controlling principle. The 2025 GS-IV Q3(c) Vivekananda quotation on the strength of a society being in the morality of its people is attributed by UPSC but is not traceable to the Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda; it should be presented with an 'attributed by UPSC' caveat rather than as a verified primary-source quotation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 41

A village where residents trust each other's testimony voluntarily participates in a social audit of MGNREGA works without any individual monetary incentive. Which concept explains why collective action occurs here without external enforcement? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Social capital refers to the networks of trust, reciprocity and civic norms among citizens and between citizens and institutions that enable collective action without requiring constant external enforcement; associated in standard usage with Robert Putnam's distinction between bonding and bridging capital.
- B. Bridging social capital (across different groups and communities) strengthens governance by enabling inclusive collective action; bonding social capital (within a close-knit group) can entrench nepotism and gatekeeping against outsiders, meaning social capital strengthens governance only when it is bridging and inclusive.
- C. Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako (sharing with others beyond one's own group) and Basava's Dasoha (sharing surplus in community service through caste-blind assemblies) are classical Indian antecedents of bridging social capital, connecting the Indian moral-thought register to the modern governance concept.
- D. MKSS-style social audits in Rajasthan and the broader jan sunwai (public hearing) model function precisely because a baseline of bridging social capital exists or is deliberately built; villagers trust the audit process and each other's testimony, making the informal complement to formal accountability architecture effective.

Answer: A

Explanation: Social capital is networks of trust enabling collective action is the controlling principle. Social capital refers to the networks of trust, reciprocity and civic norms among citizens and between citizens and institutions that enable collective action without requiring constant external enforcement; associated in standard usage with Robert Putnam's distinction between bonding and bridging capital. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 42

In a neighbouring village with deep factional divisions, a government-mandated social audit fails because no witness trusts the process or each other. Which concept's absence explains the failure? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako (sharing with others beyond one's own group) and Basava's Dasoha (sharing surplus in community service through caste-blind assemblies) are classical Indian antecedents of bridging social capital, connecting the Indian moral-thought register to the modern governance concept.
- B. Social capital refers to the networks of trust, reciprocity and civic norms among citizens and between citizens and institutions that enable collective action without requiring constant external enforcement; associated in standard usage with Robert Putnam's distinction between bonding and bridging capital.
- C. MKSS-style social audits in Rajasthan and the broader jan sunwai (public hearing) model function precisely because a baseline of bridging social capital exists or is deliberately built; villagers trust the audit process and each other's testimony, making the informal complement to formal accountability architecture effective.
- D. Bridging social capital (across different groups and communities) strengthens governance by enabling inclusive collective action; bonding social capital (within a close-knit group) can entrench nepotism and gatekeeping against outsiders, meaning social capital strengthens governance only when it is bridging and inclusive.

Answer: B

Explanation: Social capital is networks of trust enabling collective action is the controlling principle. Social capital refers to the networks of trust, reciprocity and civic norms among citizens and between citizens and institutions that enable collective action without requiring constant external enforcement; associated in standard usage with Robert Putnam's distinction between bonding and bridging capital. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 43

A dominant-caste panchayat head uses strong community networks to secure development funds but channels them exclusively to his own community. Which analytical distinction explains why strong social capital here harms rather than helps governance? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Social capital refers to the networks of trust, reciprocity and civic norms among citizens and between citizens and institutions that enable collective action without requiring constant external enforcement; associated in standard usage with Robert Putnam's distinction between bonding and bridging capital.
- B. Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako (sharing with others beyond one's own group) and Basava's Dasoha (sharing surplus in community service through caste-blind assemblies) are classical Indian antecedents of bridging social capital, connecting the Indian moral-thought register to the modern governance concept.
- C. Bridging social capital (across different groups and communities) strengthens governance by enabling inclusive collective action; bonding social capital (within a close-knit group) can entrench nepotism and gatekeeping against outsiders, meaning social capital strengthens governance only when it is bridging and inclusive.
- D. MKSS-style social audits in Rajasthan and the broader jan sunwai (public hearing) model function precisely because a baseline of bridging social capital exists or is deliberately built; villagers trust the audit process and each other's testimony, making the informal complement to formal accountability architecture effective.

Answer: C

Explanation: Bridging social capital strengthens governance; bonding-only entrenches nepotism is the controlling principle. Bridging social capital (across different groups and communities) strengthens governance by enabling inclusive collective action; bonding social capital (within a close-knit group) can entrench nepotism and gatekeeping against outsiders, meaning social capital strengthens governance only when it is bridging and inclusive. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 44

An inter-community women's self-help-group federation monitors local school attendance across caste lines and reports irregularities to the block office. Which type of social capital is at work and why does it strengthen governance? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako (sharing with others beyond one's own group) and Basava's Dasoha (sharing surplus in community service through caste-blind assemblies) are classical Indian antecedents of bridging social capital, connecting the Indian moral-thought register to the modern governance concept.
- B. MKSS-style social audits in Rajasthan and the broader jan sunwai (public hearing) model function precisely because a baseline of bridging social capital exists or is deliberately built; villagers trust the audit process and each other's testimony, making the informal complement to formal accountability architecture effective.
- C. Social capital refers to the networks of trust, reciprocity and civic norms among citizens and between citizens and institutions that enable collective action without requiring constant external enforcement; associated in standard usage with Robert Putnam's distinction between bonding and bridging capital.
- D. Bridging social capital (across different groups and communities) strengthens governance by enabling inclusive collective action; bonding social capital (within a close-knit group) can entrench nepotism and gatekeeping against outsiders, meaning social capital strengthens governance only when it is bridging and inclusive.

Answer: D

Explanation: Bridging social capital strengthens governance; bonding-only entrenches nepotism is the controlling principle. Bridging social capital (across different groups and communities) strengthens governance by enabling inclusive collective action; bonding social capital (within a close-knit group) can entrench nepotism and gatekeeping against outsiders, meaning social capital strengthens governance only when it is bridging and inclusive. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 45

A district officer establishes a common community kitchen (langar model) at the tehsil office where citizens from all communities share meals during waiting periods. Which two Indian thinkers' principles is this design drawing on as historical antecedents? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako (sharing with others beyond one's own group) and Basava's Dasoha (sharing surplus in community service through caste-blind assemblies) are classical Indian antecedents of bridging social capital, connecting the Indian moral-thought register to the modern governance concept.
- B. Social capital refers to the networks of trust, reciprocity and civic norms among citizens and between citizens and institutions that enable collective action without requiring constant external enforcement; associated in standard usage with Robert Putnam's distinction between bonding and bridging capital.
- C. Bridging social capital (across different groups and communities) strengthens governance by enabling inclusive collective action; bonding social capital (within a close-knit group) can entrench nepotism and gatekeeping against outsiders, meaning social capital strengthens governance only when it is bridging and inclusive.
- D. MKSS-style social audits in Rajasthan and the broader jan sunwai (public hearing) model function precisely because a baseline of bridging social capital exists or is deliberately built; villagers trust the audit process and each other's testimony, making the informal complement to formal accountability architecture effective.

Answer: A

Explanation: **Guru Nanak and Basava are classical antecedents of bridging social capital** is the controlling principle. Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako (sharing with others beyond one's own group) and Basava's Dasoha (sharing surplus in community service through caste-blind assemblies) are classical Indian antecedents of bridging social capital, connecting the Indian moral-thought register to the modern governance concept. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 46

A scholar argues that bridging social capital is a purely Western concept with no Indian philosophical precedent. Which two classical Indian thinkers' principles serve as counter-examples? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Bridging social capital (across different groups and communities) strengthens governance by enabling inclusive collective action; bonding social capital (within a close-knit group) can entrench nepotism and gatekeeping against outsiders, meaning social capital strengthens governance only when it is bridging and inclusive.
- B. Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako (sharing with others beyond one's own group) and Basava's Dasoha (sharing surplus in community service through caste-blind assemblies) are classical Indian antecedents of bridging social capital, connecting the Indian moral-thought register to the modern governance concept.
- C. MKSS-style social audits in Rajasthan and the broader jan sunwai (public hearing) model function precisely because a baseline of bridging social capital exists or is deliberately built; villagers trust the audit process and each other's testimony, making the informal complement to formal accountability architecture effective.
- D. Social capital refers to the networks of trust, reciprocity and civic norms among citizens and between citizens and institutions that enable collective action without requiring constant external enforcement; associated in standard usage with Robert Putnam's distinction between bonding and bridging capital.

Answer: B

Explanation: **Guru Nanak and Basava are classical antecedents of bridging social capital** is the controlling principle. Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako (sharing with others beyond one's own group) and Basava's Dasoha (sharing surplus in community service through caste-blind assemblies) are classical Indian antecedents of bridging social capital, connecting the Indian moral-thought register to the modern governance concept. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 47

A state replicates the MKSS social-audit model in a region with deep inter-community mistrust and finds that no villager testifies. Which underlying condition is missing and what must be built before the formal process can work? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Social capital refers to the networks of trust, reciprocity and civic norms among citizens and between citizens and institutions that enable collective action without requiring constant external enforcement; associated in standard usage with Robert Putnam's distinction between bonding and bridging capital.
- B. Bridging social capital (across different groups and communities) strengthens governance by enabling inclusive collective action; bonding social capital (within a close-knit group) can entrench nepotism and gatekeeping against outsiders, meaning social capital strengthens governance only when it is bridging and inclusive.
- C. MKSS-style social audits in Rajasthan and the broader jan sunwai (public hearing) model function precisely because a baseline of bridging social capital exists or is deliberately built; villagers trust the audit process and each other's testimony, making the informal complement to formal accountability architecture effective.
- D. Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako (sharing with others beyond one's own group) and Basava's Dasoha (sharing surplus in community service through caste-blind assemblies) are classical Indian antecedents of bridging social capital, connecting the Indian moral-thought register to the modern governance concept.

Answer: C

Explanation: MKSS social audits function because bridging social capital exists is the controlling principle. MKSS-style social audits in Rajasthan and the broader jan sunwai (public hearing) model function precisely because a baseline of bridging social capital exists or is deliberately built; villagers trust the audit process and each other's testimony, making the informal complement to formal accountability architecture effective. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 48

A successful social audit in Rajasthan reveals significant MGNREGA fund diversion, with villagers freely testifying about irregularities. Which concept explains why the informal accountability mechanism succeeded here but fails elsewhere? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Bridging social capital (across different groups and communities) strengthens governance by enabling inclusive collective action; bonding social capital (within a close-knit group) can entrench nepotism and gatekeeping against outsiders, meaning social capital strengthens governance only when it is bridging and inclusive.
- B. Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako (sharing with others beyond one's own group) and Basava's Dasoha (sharing surplus in community service through caste-blind assemblies) are classical Indian antecedents of bridging social capital, connecting the Indian moral-thought register to the modern governance concept.
- C. Social capital refers to the networks of trust, reciprocity and civic norms among citizens and between citizens and institutions that enable collective action without requiring constant external enforcement; associated in standard usage with Robert Putnam's distinction between bonding and bridging capital.
- D. MKSS-style social audits in Rajasthan and the broader jan sunwai (public hearing) model function precisely because a baseline of bridging social capital exists or is deliberately built; villagers trust the audit process and each other's testimony, making the informal complement to formal accountability architecture effective.

Answer: D

Explanation: MKSS social audits function because bridging social capital exists is the controlling principle. MKSS-style social audits in Rajasthan and the broader jan sunwai (public hearing) model function precisely because a baseline of bridging social capital exists or is deliberately built; villagers trust the audit process and each other's testimony, making the informal complement to formal accountability architecture effective. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Solved PYQ 1 - 2025 - 10 marks

Question: Neutral rendering: Three quotations (Thiruvalluvar, William James, Vivekananda) and their present-day meaning.

Source / ownership: Routed from 2025 GS-IV Q3; neutral rendering used. Vivekananda Q3(c) attribution caution: the 'strength of a society... morality of its people' line is not traceable to the Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda.

Model solution

Vivekananda's attributed line - the strength of a society lies in the morality of its people, not merely in its laws - asserts that formal legal architecture alone cannot sustain good governance without an underlying moral culture.

This echoes Practical Vedanta's core logic: if every citizen recognises the same self in all beings, social compliance arises from inner conviction rather than external coercion. A tax-compliance regime works better when citizens believe paying taxes is a moral duty, not merely a legal compulsion enforced by penalty.

The administrative implication is that a civil servant must invest in building civic moral culture alongside enforcing rules. Social audits, citizen charters and participatory governance work best where social capital and moral norms are strong. The limit is that moral culture alone cannot substitute for institutional safeguards; Kautilya's realist caution remains necessary.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2025 - 10 marks

Question: Neutral rendering: (b) Teachings of Mahavir and their relevance in the contemporary world.

Source / ownership: Routed from 2025 GS-IV Q4(b); neutral rendering used. Cross-linked from Topic 02 (Mahavir detail).

Model solution

Mahavir's core teachings comprise the five Mahavratas (Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya, Aparigraha) and the epistemological doctrine of Anekantavada (many-sidedness of truth) with its logical expression Syadvada (conditional predication).

Contemporary relevance: Ahimsa extends beyond physical non-violence to non-exploitation in institutional design. Aparigraha (non-possessiveness) cautions against accumulation and nepotism in public office. Anekantavada supports multi-stakeholder consultation: a land-dispute mediator who hears tribal, industrial and environmental perspectives before deciding operationalises Mahavir's epistemology.

Syadvada also disciplines official communication: conclusions should identify their evidentiary conditions instead of presenting a partial administrative view as absolute truth to affected communities.

The limit: Anekantavada taken too far risks indecision. A wisdom-based cut-off point for deliberation is still required. Mahavir's framework provides the consultative process, not the decision rule.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2024 - 10 marks

Question: Neutral rendering: Three quotations of great thinkers and their present-day meaning.

Source / ownership: Routed from 2024 GS-IV Q3; neutral rendering used. Q3(a) is a confirmed Vivekananda quotation: 'Learn everything that is good from others, but bring it in, and in your own way absorb it; do not become others' (Complete Works, Vol. III).

Model solution

Vivekananda's injunction - learn from others but absorb it in your own way - applies Practical Vedanta's selectivity to governance reform. India adopts international best practices (e-governance from Estonia, regulatory sandboxes from the UK) but must adapt them to its own institutional, cultural and constitutional context rather than transplanting them wholesale.

A civil servant implementing a foreign-inspired welfare model must assess whether the underlying assumptions (digital literacy, institutional capacity, social trust) hold in the Indian district. Uncritical adoption risks implementation failure; complete rejection forfeits improvement.

The administrative lesson is calibrated adoption: study the mechanism, test it against local conditions, and integrate what works into India's own governance architecture. This is consistent with Vivekananda's broader Practical Vedanta: universal truths exist but must be realised through one's own experience and context.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2023 - 10 marks

Question: Neutral rendering: (a) Major teachings of Guru Nanak and their contemporary relevance.

Source / ownership: Routed from 2023 GS-IV Q6(a); neutral rendering used.

Model solution

Guru Nanak's three standardly taught principles are Naam Japna (remembrance of the divine name, grounding ethical conduct in spiritual awareness), Kirat Karo (earn through honest labour) and Vand Chhako (share with others). The 'three pillars' phrasing is later pedagogical packaging; the scriptural basis is firm (Guru Granth Sahib, Angs 8 and 1245).

Contemporary relevance: Kirat Karo directly opposes rent-seeking and corruption in public service. Vand Chhako supports progressive, equity-oriented allocation of public resources. Together they form a public-finance ethic: honest revenue collection (Kirat Karo analogue) paired with equitable expenditure (Vand Chhako analogue).

Naam Japna adds an inward discipline: remembrance checks ego and keeps public authority oriented toward service rather than personal status.

The limit: Nanak's ethic is a normative ideal, not a self-enforcing mechanism. It still requires institutional accountability architecture to translate into durable governance practice.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2020 - 10 marks

Question: Neutral rendering: (a) Most relevant teachings of Buddha today and why.

Source / ownership: Routed from 2020 GS-IV Q3(a); neutral rendering used.

Model solution

The Buddha's most administratively relevant teachings are the Middle Path (Madhyama Pratipada) and the Eightfold Path, particularly Right Action, Right Livelihood and Right Mindfulness.

The Middle Path, understood as a decision-procedure, tests every administrative response against two extremes: over-reaction (punitive populist crackdown) and under-reaction (complacent inaction). A district magistrate handling a communal tension situation uses this test to avoid both provocative force and dangerous inaction, choosing proportionate preventive measures.

Right Mindfulness requires self-aware decision-making: the officer examines her own biases before acting. Right Livelihood questions whether the means of governance are themselves ethical.

The limit: the Middle Path provides the procedure for evaluating proportionality but does not prescribe the substantive standard. That requires constitutional values and legal frameworks to supply the normative content.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2020 - 10 marks

Question: Neutral rendering: Three quotations: (a) Vivekananda on selfless service and brotherhood; (b) Gandhi on finding self through service to others.

Source / ownership: Routed from 2020 GS-IV Q6; neutral rendering used. Parts (a) and (b) both route to this topic.

Model solution

Vivekananda's selfless-service teaching and Gandhi's 'finding oneself through service to others' converge on a single proposition: public service that is genuinely other-directed paradoxically fulfils the servant. Vivekananda grounds this in Practical Vedanta (serving the deprived is serving the divine), while Gandhi grounds it in Sarvodaya (welfare of all through self-purification).

Administrative application: a welfare officer who treats beneficiaries as fellow citizens rather than charity cases operates in both registers simultaneously. She designs dignified service processes and finds professional meaning in the outcomes.

Both therefore reject patronising charity: assistance must preserve agency, equality and the beneficiary's status as a rights-bearing citizen.

The shared limit: selfless service is a motivational ideal, not an institutional mechanism. Without accountability architecture, even well-motivated officers can drift into paternalism. The synthesis requires pairing internal motivation with external accountability.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2018 - 10 marks

Question: Neutral rendering: Significance of Mahatma Gandhi's thought in present times.

Source / ownership: Routed from 2018 GS-I Q3 (cross-cutting: historical and ethical anchors both linked); neutral rendering used.

Model solution

Gandhi's contemporary significance rests on three interconnected ideas: ends-means unity (impure means corrupt even a good end), trusteeship (power and wealth held for society, not as personal property), and the Seven Social Sins (politics without principles, wealth without work, and five others warning against decoupling action from ethical restraint).

Present application: ends-means unity challenges surveillance-state anti-corruption models that violate privacy rights to catch wrongdoing. Trusteeship reframes public office as fiduciary, directly rebutting the 'office as personal entitlement' mindset. The Seven Social Sins remain a diagnostic checklist for institutional failure.

The limit: Gandhi's idealism, taken alone, risks under-designing institutional safeguards. The ARC's own recommendations pair Gandhian values with Kautilyan structural controls. Gandhi's thought is necessary but not sufficient for durable governance ethics.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 8 - 2018 - 10 marks

Question: Neutral rendering: (b) Gandhi on anger and intolerance as enemies of understanding; (c) Tirukkural on falsehood and unblemished good.

Source / ownership: Routed from 2018 GS-IV Q6 parts (b) and (c); neutral rendering used. Part (a) attribution unclear in OCR; stem verified against official scan; OCR artifact resolved.

Model solution

Gandhi's warning that anger and intolerance are enemies of correct understanding links emotional regulation to ethical judgement. A civil servant who decides under anger or prejudice lacks the Right Mindfulness that both Buddhist and Gandhian ethics require. Administrative application: a collector handling a communal complaint must first manage her own emotional response before applying the law.

The Tirukkural's injunction that unblemished good arises from the absence of falsehood grounds integrity in truthful communication. An officer who conceals inconvenient audit findings to protect a superior violates this principle.

Both quotations converge on the same GS-IV answer logic: internal self-regulation (emotional and truthful) is the precondition for reliable external conduct. The limit: self-regulation alone is insufficient without institutional support structures that make truthfulness safe and anger-driven decisions reviewable.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: How does Kautilya's structural theory of official temptation remain relevant to designing modern anti-corruption controls in India? Answer in 150 words. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Kautilya's Arthashastra treats official corruption as structural rather than merely moral. The honey-and-poison passage (Kangle 2.9.32, cited in ARC Annexure-I(2)) argues that an official handling public funds can no more avoid temptation than a tongue can avoid tasting honey placed on it.

Modern relevance: India's anti-corruption architecture operationalises this premise. Mandatory rotation of procurement officers assumes opportunity creates risk. Data-analytics-driven risk-based tax audit (CBDT) replaces discretionary scrutiny with algorithmic selection, assuming some non-compliance is structural. Dual-custody financial approvals prevent single-point failure.

Kautilya also prescribes positive incentives: those who increase the king's wealth in just ways should be made permanent in office. This is an early performance-and-integrity-linked personnel policy.

The limit: a purely surveillance-based regime risks demoralising honest officials through excessive suspicion. The ARC's synthesis pairs Kautilyan controls with Gandhian service-motivation to sustain both accountability and morale.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Compare Vivekananda's Daridra Narayana and Basava's Kayaka as frameworks for dignified welfare delivery. Answer in 150 words. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Both Vivekananda and Basava refuse a charity model of welfare in which the giver is superior to the receiver. Both insist on a dignity model. But they ground dignity differently.

Vivekananda's Daridra Narayana (seeing God in the poor) derives from Advaita non-dualism: the self in all beings is one, so serving the deprived is serving the divine. This collapses the sacred-secular distinction and elevates welfare administration from bureaucratic obligation to devotional duty.

Basava's Kayakave Kailasa assigns equal spiritual worth to all honest labour regardless of caste. Dignity comes not from the giver's devotion but from the worker's own productive effort. This is a proto-egalitarian labour ethic anticipating Articles 17 and 23.

Administrative convergence: both reject stigmatising paperwork, public shaming of beneficiaries and humiliating eligibility procedures. A welfare scheme designed on either framework avoids processes that degrade the recipient. The limit: neither provides a self-enforcing mechanism; institutional accountability is still required.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Using the Buddhist Middle Path as a decision-procedure, evaluate whether India's vigilance machinery risks demoralising honest officials through excessive suspicion. Answer in 200 words. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

The Middle Path (Madhyama Pratipada) is not a static counsel to 'be moderate' but a decision-procedure: before acting, test whether the contemplated response is an over-reaction or an under-reaction and correct toward proportionality.

Applied to India's vigilance machinery, the over-reaction pole is a system that subjects all officers to pervasive surveillance, mandatory CCTV, keystroke logging and presumptive suspicion regardless of individual conduct. This discourages legitimate risk-taking: honest officers avoid discretionary decisions entirely because any decision can attract a vigilance inquiry. The ARC explicitly cautions against this demoralisation effect.

The under-reaction pole is a system that abolishes vigilance altogether, relying on moral suasion alone. Gandhi's idealism, taken without institutional support, risks precisely this under-design.

The proportionate response calibrates vigilance to risk. Risk-based audit selection targets high-discretion and high-value roles rather than blanket monitoring. Positive incentive design (recognition, tenure security, career advancement for clean records) complements punitive mechanisms. Protected dissent channels allow honest officers to raise concerns without retaliation.

The verdict: the Middle Path applied to vigilance design means matching the intensity of oversight to the risk profile of the role. Neither blanket suspicion nor blanket trust serves governance. Durable integrity requires proportionate institutional design that protects the honest while detecting the corrupt.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: How does Ambedkar's warning about a 'life of contradictions' - political equality alongside social inequality - guide a civil servant's approach to affirmative action? Answer in 200 words. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Ambedkar's 25 November 1949 Constituent Assembly speech warned that India was entering a life of contradictions: one person, one vote alongside persistent caste, gender and economic inequality. He cautioned that unless this contradiction is removed, those suffering from inequality will blow up the structure of political democracy.

For a civil servant, this warning grounds affirmative action in constitutional logic rather than mere political concession. Formal equality (identical treatment) is insufficient when starting positions are unequal. Targeted intervention - reservation, fee waivers, doorstep delivery, simplified documentation for vulnerable groups - operationalises substantive equality.

Ambedkar paired this with fraternity: without a sense of common brotherhood, liberty and equality require a policeman to enforce them. A civil servant implementing affirmative action must therefore combine institutional mechanisms with community-building that fosters social solidarity.

The limit: the 'life of contradictions' framing is a diagnosis, not a ready-made policy formula. The specific design of reservation, targeting criteria and delivery mechanisms requires separate evidence-based justification. Ambedkar provides the constitutional mandate for affirmative action; the civil servant must still design it with objectivity, transparency and periodic review.

The verdict: Ambedkar's warning converts affirmative action from an optional political gesture into a constitutional imperative. A civil servant who treats it as routine largesse rather than structural correction misreads the constitutional architecture.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: 'Indian moral thought is not monolithic - it contains an internal realist-idealist tension that durable governance ethics must hold together.' Analyse with reference to at least three Indian thinkers. Answer in 250 words. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Indian moral thought offers two complementary registers: Kautilya's structural realism and the Gandhian-Vivekanandan-Basava-Nanak idealist tradition. Durable governance ethics requires holding both together, mediated by the Buddhist Middle Path's proportionality discipline.

Kautilya's realism assumes temptation is structural. The Arthashastra's honey-and-poison passage (ARC Annexure-I(2)) justifies rotation, audit, dual custody and positive incentives for integrity. Modern institutions - Lokpal, CVC, asset-declaration regimes - are structurally Kautilyan: they assume controls are needed because goodwill alone is unreliable.

Gandhi's idealism assumes moral transformation through self-purification and example. Trusteeship reframes public office as fiduciary holding. Vivekananda's Practical Vedanta makes service to the deprived a spiritual duty, elevating welfare administration beyond bureaucratic compliance. Basava's Kayaka insists that all honest labour deserves equal dignity, anticipating anti-discrimination norms. Guru Nanak's Kirat Karo and Vand Chhako model honest earning and equitable sharing of public resources.

The danger of choosing one register alone: pure Kautilyan surveillance demoralises honest officials through excessive suspicion. Pure Gandhian idealism under-designs institutional safeguards, assuming moral suasion alone suffices.

The Buddhist Middle Path synthesises: it tests every governance response against the twin extremes of over-reaction and under-reaction. A vigilance system that calibrates oversight to risk, pairs controls with service-motivation, and protects honest officials while detecting corrupt ones operationalises this synthesis.

The verdict: the strongest GS-IV answer explicitly names the tension, assigns each thinker to the register that matches the scenario's mechanism, and closes with the synthesis point. Treating Indian moral thought as monolithically idealist or monolithically realist is both historically inaccurate and administratively inadequate.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: 'Applying medieval and ancient Indian concepts to modern governance risks anachronistic claims.' Critically evaluate, distinguishing defensible analogy from identity claim, with reference to at least three Indian moral thinkers. Answer in 250 words. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

The risk of anachronism is real. Claiming that 'ancient India already had X' - a parliament (Anubhava Mantapa), a social contract (rajadharma), a labour-rights charter (Kayaka) - collapses historical specificity and substitutes pride for analysis. But ignoring antecedents is equally distorting: it denies India's moral traditions any relevance to modern governance.

The defensible method is disciplined analogy: identify a structural parallel while explicitly naming the historical gap.

Kautilya's rajadharma is a proto-social-contract idea: the ruler's duty of protection and welfare toward subjects gives taxation its legitimacy. It is not a Lockean social contract (no consent mechanism, no right of revolution), but the structural parallel is useful for showing that accountability to the governed is not a Western import. The analogy works; the identity claim does not.

Basava's Kayaka anticipates anti-discrimination norms (Articles 17 and 23), but the Constitution has its own distinct drafting history. Basava is a historical antecedent, not a direct constitutional source. The Anubhava Mantapa is tradition-attested, not securely dated, and must never be called the 'world's first parliament.'

Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako parallels progressive taxation and equitable allocation but is not a fiscal-policy prescription. The scriptural basis is firm; the 'three pillars' framing is later pedagogical packaging.

The verdict: Indian moral thinkers enrich governance ethics through disciplined analogy that shows continuity and precedent. They lose credibility when analogy becomes identity claim. The Mains-safe formulation is: 'X anticipates / parallels Y' rather than 'X is Y' or 'India invented Y in the 12th century.' Naming the gap explicitly is what makes the comparison intellectually honest and exam-safe.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.